Alpha Delta Dynasty

League Constitution

Complete rulebook · 14 documents

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League Constitution

The official rulebook of **Alpha Delta Dynasty** — a 12-team, Superflex, full-PPR dynasty league on Sleeper.

This constitution is the final authority on all league matters. Where this document and the Sleeper platform settings disagree, **this document governs** and the commissioner will correct the platform settings.

The Rulebook

#	Document	Covers
00	Quick Reference	One-page settings card
00a	Dynasty Primer	What dynasty is, strategy basics, useful links *(not rules)*
01	League Structure	Teams, platform, dues, payouts, ownership
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00 — Quick Reference

One page. Print it, pin it in the league chat.

The League

12 teams · Dynasty · Superflex · Full PPR · Offense only · Sleeper

Starting Lineup — 10 starters

`QB · RB · RB · WR · WR · WR · TE · FLEX · FLEX · SUPERFLEX`

FLEX = RB/WR/TE · SUPERFLEX = QB/RB/WR/TE · **No K, no DEF**

Roster

Starters + bench	**23** (10 + 13)
Taxi squad	3 (rookies only, locks at Week 1 kickoff — **Week 2 in year one**)
Injured Reserve	3 (official NFL IR/PUP/NFI/Suspended only)

Scoring

Reception	1.0
Pass yd / TD / INT	0.04 / 4 / −2
Rush & rec yd / TD	0.1 / 6
Fumble lost	−2
Bonuses	None

Waivers

FAAB, $100/year, blind bid, minimum $0. Continuous, daily processing at **3:00 AM ET**, 2-day waiver period. Budgets reset at the rookie draft and **do not roll over**. Ties broken by worse standing.

Season

Regular season	Weeks 1–14
Trade deadline	Week 12, first kickoff
Playoffs	Weeks 15–17, 6 teams, top 2 seeds bye
Placement games	5th place Wk 16 · 3rd place Wk 17
Championship	Week 17
Toilet bowl	Weeks 15–17, 6 teams, **losers advance**

Toilet bowl: the six non-playoff teams. Lose and you advance. The team that loses the Week 17 final takes the **Willie Barron Trophy - Brought to you by The Pitch**. Full, legal, healthy lineups are still mandatory — you cannot lose on purpose.

Startup Draft

20 rounds · Snake · Live, one sitting, 2h30m max · Tiered clock

`R1–3: 90s · R4–10: 35s · R11–20: 15s` — no break, one sitting. 240 picks, 2h 13m worst case.

Order set by the commissioner and **not tradeable**. Remaining 3 roster spots filled by FAAB before Week 1. **Queue 45+ players beforehand.**

Rookie Draft

4 rounds · Linear (not snake) · Live, ~1 hour · 90-second flat clock

Date is set each year by league availability poll, within 4 weeks of the NFL Draft.

Picks 1–6: non-playoff teams in **reverse standings order** (set by Week 14, unaffected by the toilet bowl).

Picks 7–12: playoff teams. **Winner of each placement game gets the better pick** — 5th place game winner 1.07, loser 1.08; 3rd place game winner 1.09, loser 1.10; runner-up 1.11; champion 1.12.

Trades

Process automatically. **No league vetoes.** Reversible by the commissioner only for collusion.

Tradeable: players, rookie picks (current year + 2). Not tradeable: **FAAB**, cash, loans, future considerations, anything off-platform.

Trading is closed until the startup draft ends. No exceptions, including draft slots.

You must have paid your dues to trade a future pick.

You must make at least one trade each season to be eligible for a payout. One completed trade with another team, any time from February 1 through the Week 12 deadline. Sham trades do not count.

Money

Dues **$25** in year one, **+$10 every year after**. Due **March 1**, by Venmo or Zelle.

Pool $300 → champion **$180** (60%) · runner-up **$75** (25%) · most points **$45** (15%). Paid within 14 days of the championship.

No trade that season, no payout — the share passes to the next eligible team.

The Four Deadlines You Will Actually Miss

1. **March 1** — dues
2. **Rookie draft start** — set your queue
3. **Week 1 kickoff** — taxi squad locks (**Week 2 in year one**), and rosters must be legal *every* year
4. **Week 12 kickoff** — trades close, and your one required trade must be done

00a — Dynasty Primer

This subsection is not rules. Nothing here is binding and nothing here overrides the constitution. It exists so that an owner who has never played dynasty can sit down at the startup draft knowing what they are doing, and so that anyone can look up why this league is shaped the way it is. Where this page and a numbered document disagree, the numbered document wins.

What dynasty is

In a redraft league, everyone throws their team back in the pot every August and starts over. In a dynasty league, **you keep your entire roster forever.** There is no annual redraft, no keeper limit, no reset. The team you build in the startup draft is the team you own until you trade or cut your way into a different one.

Three things follow from that, and they change almost everything:

Every player has a value beyond this season. A 23-year-old wide receiver coming off a quiet rookie year is worth more than a 31-year-old putting up better numbers right now, because you are buying the next six years, not the next twelve weeks. Redraft rankings will steer you wrong constantly for exactly this reason.

There is an annual rookie draft. Every spring, after the NFL draft, this league holds a 4-round rookie draft for that year's incoming class. Those picks are tradeable up to three drafts out, which means "a 2029 first" is a real asset you can buy and sell today.

Trading is the engine, not a side activity. In redraft, most teams make two or three trades a year. In dynasty, trading is how rosters actually change — the waiver wire is thin because 276 players are already rostered, so the good players are all on someone's team. This league requires one trade per season to be payout-eligible for that reason.

The one idea that matters most: contending or rebuilding

Most dynasty mistakes come from teams that will not admit which one they are.

Contending means you think you can win this year. You trade future picks and young players for proven production now. You are shortening your window on purpose, and that is fine — championships are the point.

Rebuilding means you have accepted that this year is gone. You trade your aging productive players to contenders for picks and young talent while those players still have value. The mistake is not rebuilding; the mistake is waiting until your 30-year-old running back has nothing left before you sell him.

The worst place to be is the middle — a roster too old to grow and too weak to win, whose owner keeps making small moves to stay 6-8. If you are honestly not going to make a run, commit to the rebuild early. If you are close, be aggressive. In a league that never resets, indecision is the only strategy that reliably fails.

Note that rebuilding is explicitly legitimate here and **tanking is not** — see §9.3. Trade your veterans for picks all you like; you still have to start your best available lineup every week.

What is different about *this* league

Generic dynasty advice will get you close. These four things are specific and will cost you if you ignore them.

Superflex makes quarterbacks the most valuable asset in the league

You start ten players, and one slot — SUPERFLEX — can be a second quarterback. You are never required to start two, but you will want to, because a starting NFL quarterback outscores almost any flex option.

Twelve teams trying to start two QBs means **24 starting quarterbacks in a league where maybe 20 are genuinely startable.** Quarterbacks go far earlier than any redraft ranking suggests, young ones cost a fortune in trade, and a team that punts the position spends years digging out. If you take one lesson from this page: in the startup, do not be the team that waits.

Three mandatory WR slots make receivers the second scarcest thing

Three WR slots plus two flexes across twelve teams means your third receiver is, leaguewide, roughly the 36th-best at the position — a player who would be waiver fodder in a shallower league. Draft depth at receiver accordingly, and note that WRs age better than running backs, which makes them the safest long-term asset class in dynasty.

Running backs are the trap

Running backs peak early, fall off a cliff around 27, and get hurt. They also score a lot right now, which makes them feel indispensable. The standard dynasty error is paying a young-player price for a 28-year-old back. Sell them a year early rather than a year late — you will feel bad about it and you will be right.

Your $100 FAAB has to last a full calendar year

The budget is issued once, does not roll over, and does not reset until the following rookie draft. Waivers run year-round, including the offseason. An owner who empties the budget filling their roster in August cannot claim anyone in March. In year one especially, remember you leave the startup three players short and have to fill those spots out of the same $100.

The startup draft

This is the single most consequential event in the league's history and it runs 20 rounds in one 2.5-hour sitting. A few practical things:

- **Queue at least 45 players.** Rounds 11–20 are on a 15-second clock. That is enough time to confirm a queued pick and nothing else. Owners who do not queue end up on autopick, and autopick uses redraft-flavored rankings that are wrong for a dynasty superflex league.
- **Rookies are in the pool.** There is no separate rookie draft in year one — this year's incoming class is on the same board as everyone else.
- **Both strategies work.** "Draft young and win in three years" and "draft the best players and win now" are both legitimate openings. What does not work is doing half of each by accident.
- **No trading until the final pick.** Not before, not during. Nobody can price anything yet, which is exactly why.

Rookie picks are currency

A first-round rookie pick in a superflex league is a genuinely valuable asset, and picks two and three years out trade constantly. Some orientation:

- Picks 1.01–1.06 go to the six teams that missed the playoffs, in reverse order of the regular-season standings. Picks 1.07–1.12 go to playoff teams, decided by placement games.
- **Future picks are cheap to sell and expensive to buy back.** A rebuilding team should be accumulating them; a contender should be spending them. Just know that "my 2029 first" feels free right now and will not in 2029.
- You cannot trade a future pick if you have not paid your dues (§8.3).

The taxi squad, briefly

Three slots, rookies only. Players parked there do not count against your 23-man active roster and cannot be started. It exists so that stashing a developmental rookie does not cost you a bench spot you need in September.

The rule that surprises everyone: **promotion is one-way.** You can pull a taxi player up into your lineup at any point in the season, but you can never send him back down. If your third-round rookie breaks out in Week 6, use him — you just cannot undo it.

How to actually trade

The most common reason a dynasty league dies is that nobody trades. Some things that help:

- **Send real offers, not fishing expeditions.** "Anyone interested in my RB?" gets ignored. A specific two-for-one with a name on it gets a response.
- **Answer every offer, even to decline.** A one-word "no thanks" within a day is the whole social contract here, and it is in §9.6.
- **Value differences are the point.** Trades happen because a rebuilder and a contender price a 29-year-old differently. If everyone agreed on values, nothing would ever trade.
- **There are no vetoes.** Trades process automatically and the commissioner reverses only for collusion, which means a trade you think is bad. A lopsided-looking trade is not grounds for anything.

Common first-year mistakes

1. **Punting quarterback in a superflex startup.** The most expensive error available to you.
2. **Using redraft rankings.** They ignore age entirely. Use dynasty-specific values, set to superflex.
3. **Overvaluing your own rookies.** Everyone thinks their third-rounder is the next star. Most are not.
4. **Spending the whole FAAB budget in August.** It has to cover twelve months.
5. **Refusing to sell a declining veteran** because you drafted him and he was good once.
6. **Going quiet.** The rulebook requires one trade a season for a payout, but the real cost of disengaging is that your roster ages in place while everyone else's improves.

Helpful websites

Value and trade tools — **set every one of these to Superflex before you trust a number.** They default to 1QB, and 1QB values are badly wrong for this league.

Site	What it's good for
KeepTradeCut	Crowdsourced dynasty values and a trade calculator. The most widely used common language for "is this fair?"
FantasyCalc	Values derived from trades actually executed in real leagues, configurable for superflex and roster size
DynastyProcess	Free value charts and calculators, data-driven and updated often
Dynasty League Football	Long-running dynasty site: rankings, rookie profiles, startup ADP
Dynasty Nerds	Rankings, rookie film work, and a dynasty-specific podcast

Research and news:

Site	What it's good for
FantasyPros	Consensus rankings, news aggregation, injury tracking
PlayerProfiler	Athletic profiles, target share, opportunity metrics — useful for evaluating young players
r/DynastyFF	Active community, trade advice threads, rookie discussion
Sleeper Support	The platform's own documentation — worth reading the taxi squad article before Week 1

Where to go next

- Quick Reference — every setting on one page. Print it.
- Rosters & Lineups — what you can start and how many players you control.
- Startup Draft — read this before draft night, not during it.
- Trades — including the one-trade-per-season payout requirement.

01 — League Structure

1.1 Format

Setting	Value
Teams	12
Type	Dynasty (full roster retention, no annual redraft)
Lineup	Superflex
Scoring	Full PPR (1.0 per reception)
Player pool	Offense only — QB, RB, WR, TE
Platform	Sleeper
League year	February 1 – January 31

1.2 Ownership

One team, one owner. Co-ownership is not permitted. A team is owned by exactly one person, who is solely responsible for that team's lineups, transactions, dues, and conduct.

An owner may not hold an ownership interest in any other team in this league, directly or through a family member or household member. If two owners share a household, they must disclose it to the commissioner before the startup draft; the commissioner may permit it but both owners are subject to heightened trade review (see Trades §8.6).

Owners are expected to run their own team. Handing your account credentials to another owner, or having someone else set your lineup for more than an occasional emergency, is a violation.

1.3 The Commissioner

The commissioner is **Thayer Hicks**.

The commissioner:

- Administers the Sleeper league and keeps its settings matched to this document.
- Sets and enforces the league calendar.
- Collects dues and distributes payouts.
- Rules on disputes not clearly answered by this document.
- Investigates suspected collusion, tanking, and abandonment.
- Fills vacant teams.

The commissioner **also owns a team** and is bound by every rule in this document.

Commissioner accountability. The commissioner may not use commissioner tools to alter their own roster, force a transaction involving their own team, or reverse a result affecting their own team. Any such action requires a league vote. Commissioner trades are subject to the same review as everyone else's, with the review conducted by the co-commissioner.

Co-commissioner. A second owner, **Sawyer Fotheringham**, serves as co-commissioner. Their role is to review the commissioner's own trades, hold a backup set of platform credentials, and act as commissioner if the commissioner is unavailable or has a conflict of interest.

Removal. The commissioner may be removed by a vote of 9 of the 12 owners. See Governance §9.2.

1.4 Dues

Dues **start at $25** for the inaugural season and **rise by $10 every year thereafter**.

Season	Dues	Prize pool
Year 1	$25	$300
Year 2	$35	$420
Year 3	$45	$540
Year 4	$55	$660
Each year after	*+$10*	*+$120*

The escalator is the point, not an accident. A $25 buy-in is low enough that nobody hesitates to join a league that has not proven itself yet, and the annual increase means the stakes grow alongside the rosters — by the time your team is five years of drafting and trading deep, there is real money on it. It also functions as a soft commitment test: an owner who balks at the increase is usually an owner who was already drifting away.

Terms.

- Dues are paid to the commissioner by **Venmo, Zelle, or directly through the Sleeper app**.
- Dues are due by **March 1** each year, before the rookie draft and before the league year's meaningful roster decisions.
- **An owner who has not paid dues may not trade a future draft pick**, in either direction. This is the single most important dues rule in a dynasty league — future picks are only worth something if the team owing them is still paying to exist.
- An owner who has not paid by March 1 receives one written warning and seven days. After that the team is declared vacant and handled under Governance §9.5.
- Dues are non-refundable once the rookie draft has begun.

Startup year exception: dues for the inaugural season are due before the startup draft begins. No owner picks until every owner has paid.

1.5 Payouts

The prize pool is 100% of collected dues — **$300 in year one**, growing by $120 each season as dues escalate. The commissioner takes no cut.

Finish	Share	Year 1
Champion	60%	**$180**
Runner-up	25%	**$75**
Most regular-season points	15%	**$45**

"Most regular-season points" is close to universal in dynasty leagues. It pays the team that got unlucky rather than bad, and it is one of the few payouts a tanking team cannot chase.

Eligibility — you must trade. An owner who has not completed at least one trade during the season is **not eligible for any payout**, regardless of where they finish. A forfeited share passes to the next eligible team in that category. The full rule, including what counts as a qualifying trade, is Trades §8.8.

Payment timing. Payouts are distributed within 14 days of the championship game.

1.6 League Communication

The official league channel is the **league group text**.

- Rule announcements, deadlines, and votes happen there. Anything announced there is considered received by every owner.
- Trade negotiations may happen anywhere, but the executed trade must go through Sleeper. Nothing agreed outside the platform is binding.
- Owners are expected to be reachable. See Governance §9.4.

02 — Rosters & Lineups

2.1 Starting Lineup

Ten starters each week.

Slot	Eligible positions
QB	QB
RB	RB
RB	RB
WR	WR
WR	WR
WR	WR
TE	TE
FLEX	RB / WR / TE
FLEX	RB / WR / TE
SUPERFLEX	**QB / RB / WR / TE**

No kickers. No team defenses. Neither is rostered in this league at all.

The SUPERFLEX slot is what defines the format. You are not required to start two quarterbacks, but you almost always will — and that is the point. It makes QBs scarce, valuable, and worth drafting and trading for, which is the main thing 1QB dynasty leagues get wrong.

This is a deep lineup, on purpose. Ten starters across twelve teams means 120 starting slots every week, including 36 mandatory wide receiver slots before either flex is filled. Two consequences worth knowing before the startup draft:

- **Wide receiver is the scarcest position after quarterback.** A team's third WR is, leaguewide, roughly the 36th-best receiver — a range that in shallower leagues is waiver fodder. Draft accordingly.
- **Your bench is sized to cover this lineup, not to speculate with** (see §2.2). Thirteen spots behind ten starters is a little over one backup apiece — enough to survive a stacked bye week, not enough to hoard. The waiver wire still matters more here than it would in a league starting eight.

Illegal lineups. A lineup with an empty starting slot, or with a player on bye, scores zero for that slot. Failing to set a legal lineup is an inactivity and integrity issue, not just a bad week — see Governance §9.3.

2.2 Roster Limits

Roster area	Slots
Starters	10
Bench	13
Active roster	**23**
Taxi squad	3
Injured Reserve	3
Maximum players controlled	**29**

Thirteen bench spots behind ten starting slots leaves a workable margin — a little over one backup per starter. It keeps 276 players rostered leaguewide rather than 300, so real talent still circulates through free agency and a rebuild remains executable, while giving you enough depth to survive a stacked bye week without gutting your lineup.

Compliance. Rosters must be legal (at or under every limit) at these moments:

- **Kickoff of NFL Week 1** — the hard annual cutdown.
- **Every waiver processing run** — Sleeper will not process a claim that would put you over the limit unless you attach a drop.

Rosters may exceed the active limit during the offseason *only* between the start of the rookie draft and Week 1 kickoff, and only because of rookie draft selections. While over the limit, Sleeper locks your starting lineup and blocks free agent claims — harmless in May, fatal in September.

Any team over the limit at Week 1 kickoff has players dropped by the commissioner, lowest-rostered-percentage first, after one warning.

2.3 Taxi Squad

Three taxi slots. Players on the taxi squad do not count against the 23-man active roster and **cannot be started**. This is your developmental stash.

Eligibility: rookies only. First-year players, in the season they are drafted — Sleeper setting: max experience 1 year, non-rookies disabled. The taxi squad does exactly one job in this league, which is warehousing the current rookie class.

Rules of the taxi squad.

1. **Waiver and free agent claims cannot go directly to taxi.** Sleeper requires a claimed player to land on your active roster first, then be moved to taxi. You need an open active spot to make the claim.
2. **Rookie draft picks are the exception.** You may draft over the roster limit and move your rookies to taxi afterward — no pre-draft cutdown required. See Rookie Draft §6.1.
3. **The taxi deadline is kickoff of NFL Week 1** — except in the inaugural season, when it is **kickoff of NFL Week 2**. After the deadline passes, no player may be moved *onto* taxi for the rest of the season.
4. **Promotion is one-way and permanent.** You may promote a taxi player to your active roster at any time, but once promoted after the deadline they can never return to taxi that season.

5. **Promoting requires an open active roster spot.** If you are at 23, you must drop or trade someone first.
6. **Taxi players are yours.** Sleeper does not support taxi raiding or poaching, and this league does not either. Taxi players may be traded normally.
7. **Taxi players may be dropped**, and go through waivers like anyone else.
8. **Eligibility resets at the end of each season.** A player whose experience has aged past the limit must be promoted to the active roster before Week 1 or dropped.

> **The inaugural season gets one extra week.** In year one only, the taxi deadline is kickoff of **Week 2** rather than Week 1. The startup draft is 20 rounds run in a single 2.5-hour sitting, and the rookies you take in it arrive alongside 20 other players with no offseason to sort them — one extra week to work out which three belong on taxi is a reasonable allowance for a league that has existed for a few weeks. From the second season onward the deadline is Week 1 kickoff, permanently.
>
> **The roster compliance deadline does not move.** Even in year one you must be at or under every limit at **Week 1 kickoff** (§2.2). The extra week buys you time to decide *which* players go to taxi, not permission to carry an oversized roster into the season. A player whose NFL game has already kicked off in Week 1 is locked and cannot be moved that week.

> **On mid-season promotion.** Rules 3 and 4 are the ones that surprise people new to dynasty. The taxi deadline restricts one direction only — you may promote a taxi player into your lineup at any point in the season, but you can never send him back. Sleeper enforces this and it is not configurable: *"Players can always be moved out of taxi slots onto the bench or starting positions in the season."* See Sleeper — How do taxi squads work?.
>
> This is deliberate, not a loophole. If taxi players were frozen for the year, taxi slots would be strictly worse bench spots and stashing a rookie who breaks out in Week 6 would punish you for being right. The cost of the taxi squad is that the player scores nothing while he sits, that promoting him costs an active roster spot, and that the move is irreversible — not that he is unusable.

2.4 Injured Reserve

Three IR slots. IR players do not count against the active roster limit.

Eligibility is enforced by the platform, not by opinion. A player may occupy an IR slot only while Sleeper lists them with an official NFL designation of **IR, PUP, NFI, COVID, or Suspended**. "Doubtful," "Out," and "Questionable" do not qualify.

- When a player's designation clears, you have **48 hours** to move them to your active roster or drop them. Sleeper flags this automatically.
- A roster that is illegal because of a cleared IR player cannot process waiver claims.
- IR players may be traded.

2.5 Player Eligibility

- A player's position is whatever **Sleeper** lists. Position changes mid-season follow the platform; the commissioner does not adjudicate them.

- Only players on an NFL roster, practice squad, or the current year's NFL draft class may be rostered. College players who have not declared are **not** eligible — this is not a devy league.
- Retired players may be held on IR only if the NFL/Sleeper designation supports it; otherwise they must be dropped.

03 — Scoring

Full PPR. The table below is the complete scoring system; anything not listed scores zero.

3.1 Passing

Event	Points
Passing yards	**0.04** per yard (1 pt per 25 yards)
Passing touchdown	**4**
Interception thrown	**−2**
2-point conversion (pass)	**2**

Four points per passing touchdown, not six. In a Superflex league the SUPERFLEX slot already does the work of making quarterbacks valuable; inflating their scoring on top of it would make QB not merely the most important position but the only one that matters.

3.2 Rushing

Event	Points
Rushing yards	**0.1** per yard (1 pt per 10 yards)
Rushing touchdown	**6**
2-point conversion (rush)	**2**

3.3 Receiving

Event	Points
Reception	**1.0**
Receiving yards	**0.1** per yard (1 pt per 10 yards)
Receiving touchdown	**6**
2-point conversion (reception)	**2**

No tight end premium. Every position scores 1.0 per reception. This keeps the league's scoring aligned with the widest available set of published rankings and ADP data, which matters more than usual in a startup year where nobody has league history to price players against.

3.4 Miscellaneous

Event	Points
Fumble lost	**−2**
Fumble recovered for TD (own)	**6**
Special teams / return TD (by an offensive player)	**6**

No bonuses. This league does not use yardage milestone bonuses (100-yard games, 300-yard passing games, long-TD bonuses). They add variance without adding decisions, and they make scoring harder to reason about in trades.

No negative points for kneel-downs, sacks taken, or incompletions.

3.5 Fractional Scoring

All scoring is to **two decimal places**. There are no ties in a matchup unless both teams score exactly the same to the hundredth — see Schedule & Playoffs §4.4.

3.6 Stat Corrections

The league uses **Sleeper's final official stats**. Sleeper applies NFL stat corrections automatically, usually through the following Tuesday.

- Matchup results are **final when Sleeper marks the week complete**. A stat correction that arrives after that point does not change a result.
- The one exception: a correction that would change a **playoff** result is honored whenever it arrives, up until payouts are distributed. Championships are worth getting right.

3.7 Changing Scoring

Scoring changes require a **9-of-12 supermajority** and may only take effect the following season — never mid-season, and never after the rookie draft. See Governance §9.2.

The reason for the high bar: in a dynasty league, scoring settings *are* asset values. Changing the passing TD value or adding TE premium retroactively reprices every roster in the league and rewards whoever saw it coming.

04 — Schedule & Playoffs

4.1 Regular Season

Weeks 1–14. Fourteen head-to-head matchups.

No divisions. All twelve teams sit in one table. Each team plays eleven opponents once and three opponents twice.

This matters more in dynasty than it would in redraft: the standings are a clean ranking of 1 through 12, and that ranking directly sets the rookie draft order. No team backs into the playoffs off a weak division, and no 6-8 division winner distorts next spring's draft.

Scheduling. The schedule is generated by Sleeper before Week 1 and is not adjusted afterward.

4.2 Playoffs

Weeks 15, 16, and 17. Six teams. The top two seeds receive a first-round bye.

Round	Week	Matchups	Decides
Wild card	15	3 v 6, 4 v 5	Who advances
Semifinal	16	1 v lowest remaining seed, 2 v other	Who plays for the title
5th place game	16	The two wild card losers	5th/6th place and **picks 1.07 / 1.08**
Championship	17	Semifinal winners	Champion and runner-up
3rd place game	17	The two semifinal losers	3rd/4th place and **picks 1.09 / 1.10**

Nobody's season ends early. Every playoff team plays all three weeks. Lose in the wild card round and you are still playing in Week 16 with a draft pick on the line; lose in the semifinal and you are still playing in Week 17. There is no week in which a playoff team has nothing to play for, which is the entire reason the placement games exist.

The winner of a placement game gets the better pick. This is the opposite of the usual convention, and it is deliberate. If the loser of the 5th place game took 1.07, the game would be worth losing and we would have built a tanking incentive into the postseason on purpose. Winning is rewarded at every stage, so a complete lineup is always in your interest as well as required by §9.3.

Placement games use the same tiebreakers as any playoff game (§4.4).

Why week 17 and not week 18. NFL teams rest starters in Week 18. Ending the fantasy season in Week 17 is now near-universal and this league does the same.

Reseeding happens after the wild card round: the highest remaining seed always plays the lowest remaining seed.

Playoff seeding is by regular-season standings, with ties broken per §4.3.

No single-week reseeding of byes. Byes are locked to seeds 1 and 2 at the end of Week 14.

4.3 Standings Tiebreakers

Applied in order until the tie is broken:

1. **Head-to-head record** (only if the tied teams played, and only if it is decisive among all tied teams)
2. **Total points scored**
3. **Total points against** (lower is better)
4. **Best single-week score**
5. **Coin flip by the commissioner**, conducted publicly in the league chat

If more than two teams are tied, apply each step to the whole group; when the group splits, restart the sequence for the remaining tied teams.

4.4 Ties

Regular season: a matchup tied to the hundredth of a point is recorded as a tie (0.5 win, 0.5 loss).

Playoffs: ties are broken by, in order:

1. Higher regular-season seed
2. Higher regular-season points scored

There are no bench-points or overtime tiebreakers. The higher seed earned the tiebreak during the season.

4.5 The Toilet Bowl

The six teams that miss the playoffs play a **toilet bowl** in weeks 15–17. It is not a consolation bracket. **Losers advance.** Win a game and you are out; lose and you move one round closer to the **Willie Barron Trophy - Brought to you by The Pitch**, which is awarded to the team that loses the toilet bowl final.

Seeding is by regular-season finish — seed 7 is the best non-playoff team, seed 12 the worst. The bracket mirrors the playoff bracket, inverted: where the two best teams in the league get a bye that helps them, the two worst get a bye that pushes them toward the trophy.

Round	Week	Matchups	Who advances
First round	15	7 v 10, 8 v 9	The **losers**. Seeds 11 and 12 have byes.
Semifinal	16	12 v highest remaining seed, 11 v other	The **losers**
Toilet Bowl final	17	The two remaining teams	The **loser** takes the Willie Barron Trophy - Brought to you by The Pitch

A team that wins its first toilet bowl game is finished for the season. Its escape is complete and it plays no further meaningful games.

You must still field a complete, legal, healthy lineup every week. This is the part that makes the toilet bowl work rather than turning it into a farce. §9.3 applies in full through Week 17: you may not bench a healthy starter, start a player on bye, or leave a slot empty in order to lose. Sitting your best players to chase the trophy carries the same penalties as

sitting them to chase a draft pick.

The result is that nobody can steer the outcome. You field your real team, and whether you take the trophy home is decided by three weeks of scoring you do not control. That is the joke, and it only lands if everyone is genuinely trying to win.

The toilet bowl does not determine the rookie draft order. Picks 1.01–1.06 are locked by regular-season finish at the end of Week 14 and nothing in weeks 15–17 moves them — see Rookie Draft §6.2. This is deliberate and important. If the toilet bowl set the draft order, every team in it would be trying to lose games that also decide their draft position, which is the exact problem the draft-order rule exists to solve.

This is the opposite arrangement from the playoff side, and for the opposite reason. Playoff teams have their picks decided by placement games because those games reward winning; the toilet bowl rewards winning too, but by letting you *escape* rather than by paying you a draft slot. Both halves of the league spend weeks 15–17 trying to win. Neither half can improve its draft position by losing.

A note on the incentives. The toilet bowl quietly works against regular-season tanking. Finishing 12th gets you the 1.01, but it also gets you a bye straight into the toilet bowl semifinal and two games from the Willie Barron Trophy - Brought to you by The Pitch. Tanking now has a price attached, paid in front of the whole league.

Running the bracket. Sleeper's consolation bracket advances winners, which is the opposite of this. The commissioner posts the toilet bowl bracket in the group text before Week 15 and tracks it by hand from Sleeper's weekly scores. Where the platform's display and this section disagree, this section governs.

05 — Startup Draft

The inaugural draft. This happens once, and it is the single most consequential event in the league's history — every asset every team will ever own traces back to it.

5.1 Format

Snake (serpentine). Order reverses each round: the team picking 1st in round one picks 12th in round two, 1st again in round three, and so on.

Rounds: 20. The startup does not quite fill your roster. Each team leaves the draft with 20 players and fills its remaining **3 roster spots** through FAAB before Week 1 — see §5.5.

This is a deliberate concession to the calendar. A startup that fills all 23 roster spots is 276 picks, and 276 picks cannot be drafted well in 2.5 hours — that is under 33 seconds per pick with no allowance for early rounds taking longer. Round count is the only lever that buys real thinking time where it matters, and 20 is as far as it stretches: at 240 picks the tiered clock below lands at 2h 13m, and every round past that eats into the technical-pause budget. The rounds you lose are 21 through 23, which in any startup are close to indistinguishable from waiver-wire claims anyway.

Player pool: all NFL offensive players (QB/RB/WR/TE) **plus the current year's incoming rookie class**.

The incoming rookie class is in the startup pool. Every asset sits on one board and everyone competes for the same players. There is **no separate rookie draft in year one** — the first rookie draft happens the following spring.

5.2 Draft Order

The draft order is set by the commissioner. It is determined by a secret challenge run by the commissioner, and announced before the draft begins.

The order is final once announced. The commissioner does not have to explain the mechanism, but the order must be posted in the league chat before the first pick, and it does not change afterward for any reason.

Draft slots may not be traded. The slot you are assigned is the slot you draft from. It cannot be sold, swapped, or packaged into a trade at any point.

The order is the outcome of the secret challenge, and a prize that can be bought is not a prize. This also removes the one pre-draft negotiation that no owner has any information with which to price — before a single pick has been made, nobody in a brand-new league knows what the 1.01 slot is actually worth.

Straight snake, no third-round reversal. Rounds run $1 \to 12$, $12 \to 1$, $1 \to 12$, $12 \to 1$, and so on for all 20 rounds. The order the secret challenge produces is a real prize, and softening it would defeat the purpose of playing for it.

5.3 Timing

Format: live draft, one sitting, 2 hours 30 minutes maximum.

The clock is **tiered** across three blocks — early picks get real time, late picks move fast. Rounds 1–3 are where the league is actually built; rounds 11–20 are lottery tickets and should be drafted like it.

Rounds	Picks	Clock per pick	Worst-case time
1–3	36	**90 sec**	54m
4–10	84	**35 sec**	49m
11–20	120	**15 sec**	30m
Total	**240**		**2h 13m**

No scheduled break. The draft runs start to finish in one sitting. Worst case is **2h 13m**, 17 minutes under the 2.5-hour ceiling — which is exactly the room needed to absorb the full technical-pause budget below and still finish on time. Handle food, drinks, and anything else before the first pick.

The table assumes *every owner burns their entire clock on every pick*, which never happens. A live draft with prepared owners typically consumes 50–65% of the clock, so the realistic finish is **90 minutes to 1 hour 45**.

Autopick on expiry: yes — best player available by Sleeper ranking.

How the tiered clock is run

Sleeper has a single pick-timer setting, but the commissioner can change it while the draft is live. Three tiers means **two changes**, both announced in the draft chat one round in advance:

Before round	Set timer to
4	35 sec
11	15 sec

Changing the timer does not affect a pick already on the clock.

What owners must do beforehand

A 2.5-hour draft only works if people arrive prepared. This is not optional:

1. **Queue at least 45 players** in the Sleeper app before the draft starts. Twenty rounds means 240 players come off the board, so a shallow queue is empty by round 14. In rounds 11–20 you have 15 seconds; that is enough time to confirm a queued pick and nothing else.
2. **Draft from a computer or tablet**, not a phone, if you have the option.
3. **Be in the room five minutes early.** The draft starts on time.
4. **Know your Superflex plan before pick one.** Round 1 is 90 seconds — enough to react to a surprise, not enough to form a strategy.

Pauses

The commissioner may pause the draft for a **technical failure only** — a platform outage or an owner disconnecting. Pauses are capped at **5 minutes each and 15 minutes total**, and that budget is inside the 2.5-hour ceiling.

The draft is **not** paused for deliberation, and it is not paused for trades — there are no trades.

If an owner cannot attend

Autopick handles it. An absent owner's queue drafts for them, and a queue built in advance will produce a perfectly reasonable roster. An owner who knows they will be absent should tell the commissioner and queue 65+ players rather than 45.

5.4 No Trading Until the Startup Concludes

No trades of any kind are permitted until the startup draft is over. Not before it, not during it. This covers players, draft slots, individual picks within the startup, and FAAB.

Trading opens the moment the final pick of the startup is made, and from then on runs under the normal trade rules.

Two reasons. First, a 2.5-hour live draft has no room in it to negotiate and process a trade — a single mid-draft trade would eat the entire slack budget. Second, nobody in a brand-new league can price anything yet: before a single pick is made, no owner has any basis for valuing the 1.01 slot, a 2028 second-rounder, or a player they have never rostered. The trades that would get made in that window are the ones people regret for years.

5.5 After the Draft

- **Trading opens immediately**, under the normal trade rules.
- **FAAB budgets are issued** — $100 per team. See Waivers §7.1.
- **Teams are 3 players short of a full roster** and fill the gap through FAAB. All undrafted players enter the free agent pool and are claimed through the normal daily waiver process.
- Budget accordingly: the preseason roster-filling period is the first real call on your $100, and an owner who spends aggressively to finish their roster in August has little left for the Week 3 waiver break-out.
- Rosters must be legal at **Week 1 kickoff**, not at the end of the draft.
- The taxi squad opens immediately. Because this is the inaugural season, rookies may be moved to taxi any time up to **kickoff of Week 2** — one extra week, granted only in year one (Rosters §2.3). Your roster must still be legal at **Week 1 kickoff**.

06 — Rookie Draft

Every spring, after the NFL Draft. This is the league's annual heartbeat and the mechanism by which bad teams get better.

6.1 Format

Setting	Value
Rounds	**4**
Order type	**Linear** (same order every round — *not* a snake)
Player pool	Current-year NFL rookies only
Format	**Live draft, one sitting**
Timing	A date set each year by the commissioner, within **4 weeks of the NFL Draft**
Pick clock	**90 seconds**, flat — no tiers
Length	48 picks · **72 minutes** worst case, realistically 40–50
Exception	A distressed-orphan compensatory pick adds a 49th pick at the end of round 2 in the year it is awarded
Autopick	Yes, best available by Sleeper ranking

Why linear and not snake. In a rookie draft the order already reflects last season's standings; snaking it hands the best team the 1.12 *and* the 2.01 back-to-back and blunts the whole point. Linear is the dynasty standard.

Why a flat clock. The startup needs a tiered clock because it is 240 picks. This draft is 48. At 90 seconds a pick the whole thing fits in 72 minutes even if every owner burns every second, so there is nothing to optimize and no reason to make the commissioner fiddle with settings mid-draft. One value, set once.

Why 4 rounds. Superflex leagues start ten players and rookie classes reliably produce ~48 worth stashing. Note the churn this creates against a 23-man roster: four incoming rookies a year means clearing four spots a year, roughly a third of your thirteen-man bench. The taxi squad absorbs three of them, which is precisely what it is for. Three rounds is the other common answer and would be the move if the annual cutdown starts feeling forced.

Roster space — you do not need any. Draft all of your picks regardless of how full your roster is. Sleeper permits drafting over the roster limit, so nobody has to cut four useful players in May to make room for rookies who are headed to the taxi squad anyway.

After the draft, move your rookies to taxi and drop whoever you were going to drop. Moving players to taxi and IR is permitted *while* you are over the limit, so the sequence works in the order you'd want it to.

The one catch: while a roster is over the limit, Sleeper locks your starting lineup and blocks free agent claims. That costs you nothing in May, but it means you must be back under the limit before your first matchup. The hard deadline is **Week 1 kickoff**, the same as every other roster compliance check (Rosters §2.2).

Undrafted rookies become free agents when the rookie draft concludes and are subject to the normal waiver process.

Scheduling the draft

The date is **not fixed in this constitution** and changes every year. It is scheduled around the league's actual availability, because a live draft that half the league misses is worse than no live draft at all.

The commissioner runs this process:

1. **Within 3 days of the NFL Draft ending**, the commissioner posts a poll in the league chat with at least four candidate dates and times.
2. **Owners respond within 5 days.** No response is treated as "available for anything" — if you do not vote, you do not get to complain about the date.
3. **The commissioner announces the date**, choosing whichever slot the most owners can make. Ties go to the commissioner's judgment. The announcement comes with **at least 10 days' notice**.
4. **The date is locked once announced.** It moves only for a genuine leaguewide problem, never for one owner's schedule.

The outer boundary: the draft must be held **no later than 4 weeks after the NFL Draft concludes**. Rookie draft season is the best part of the dynasty offseason and letting it slide into July drains the momentum out of it. Inside that window, any date is fair game.

If you cannot make it. Queue your players and let autopick draft for you — with 4 rounds and a good queue this produces a fine result. Alternatively, send the commissioner a written ranked list before the draft and the commissioner will pick from it on your behalf.

Owners may **not** hand their draft to another owner. Autopick or a written list to the commissioner are the only two options, because an owner drafting for someone else is a collusion question nobody needs.

6.2 Draft Order

The six teams that **missed the playoffs** pick first (slots 1.01–1.06), followed by the six **playoff teams** (slots 1.07–1.12).

Playoff teams (picks 7–12) are ordered by how deep they went, and within each pair by the result of a placement game:

Pick	Team	Final place
1.07	**Winner** of the 5th place game (Week 16)	5th
1.08	**Loser** of the 5th place game	6th
1.09	**Winner** of the 3rd place game (Week 17)	3rd
1.10	**Loser** of the 3rd place game	4th
1.11	Runner-up	2nd
1.12	Champion	1st

The winner of each placement game takes the better pick. How far you advanced sets your band — wild card losers pick at 1.07–1.08, semifinal losers at 1.09–1.10, finalists at 1.11–1.12 — and inside that band, winning the placement game moves you up a slot rather than down. That inversion is on purpose: an eliminated team should never be in a game it profits from losing.

Honest caveat. Advancing a round still costs you two draft slots — lose the wild card game and you are in the 1.07–1.08 band, win it and the best you can do is 1.09. That is true in every league that orders picks by playoff finish, and the counterweight is $180 for the championship and $75 for the runner-up (Structure §1.5) against two slots at the back of round 1. Deliberately losing a playoff game to improve a pick is a §9.3 violation, and the penalty for a pattern of it is forfeiting a first-round pick — strictly worse than anything the tank would earn.

Non-playoff teams (picks 1–6) are ordered by **reverse order of the regular-season standings.** The worst record picks 1.01, the sixth-worst picks 1.06. Ties are broken by fewest points scored.

This is the system the NFL uses and the one every owner understands without explanation. Its known weakness is that it rewards losing: once a team is mathematically eliminated, finishing 12th is strictly better than finishing 7th. The league accepts that trade in exchange for a draft order nobody has to argue about, and leans on §9.3 — the requirement to field a complete, healthy lineup every week, enforced by the commissioner on their own initiative — to keep it honest.

If tanking becomes a visible problem, a weighted lottery among the six non-playoff teams is the standard remedy and can be adopted through the normal amendment process. Adopt it in an offseason where nobody has yet benefited from it.

When the order is set. Immediately after the championship game, and posted in the league group text.

6.3 Trading Rookie Picks

Rookie picks are tradeable — see Trades §8.3 for the full rules, including the requirement that **dues be paid before trading a future pick**.

Picks in the current year's rookie draft may be traded up until the moment they are on the clock — including during the draft itself, which is half the fun of a live rookie draft.

Because the draft is live, trade pauses are tightly capped: the commissioner may pause the clock for up to **5 minutes**, no more than **3 times** in the draft. A trade that cannot be agreed and entered into Sleeper inside 5 minutes waits until the draft is over.

6.4 No Supplemental or Free-Agent Rounds

There is no veteran/free-agent draft. All non-rookie player acquisition happens through waivers and free agency year-round.

07 — Waivers & Free Agency

This league uses **FAAB** (Free Agent Acquisition Budget) — blind bidding — for all player acquisitions. There is no rolling waiver priority list.

7.1 FAAB Budget

Each team receives **$100** per league year.

- The budget is issued **at the conclusion of the rookie draft** and runs until the following rookie draft.
- In the startup year, budgets are issued at the conclusion of the startup draft.
- **Budgets do not roll over.** Unspent money is gone. Sleeper does not reset budgets automatically; the commissioner resets them manually each year.
- Minimum bid is **$0**. A $0 bid is a legitimate bid and competes normally.
- **FAAB may not be traded** in any form — see Trades §8.4.

The budget is **$100**, not a larger figure. Bids stay legible at a glance — "$14" reads instantly as 14% of your season. The cost is occasional tied bids, which §7.3 resolves.

7.2 How Waivers Work

Every dropped or newly available player goes through waivers. There is no free-agent free-for-all period; nothing in this league is claimed first-come, first-served, at any point in the year.

Setting	Value
Waiver type	FAAB, continuous
Waiver period	**2 days**
Processing time	**3:00 AM ET, daily**
Bid visibility	Blind — all bids hidden until processing

- A dropped player is on waivers for 2 days, then processes at the next 3:00 AM run.
- You may submit claims on as many players as you like, and order them by priority. Sleeper processes your claims in your stated order and stops honoring them once you run out of budget or roster space.
- Every claim must include a corresponding drop if you are at your roster limit. A claim that would create an illegal roster fails.
- **Waivers run year-round**, including the offseason. There is no dead period.

7.3 Tiebreakers

If two teams bid the same amount on the same player, the tie is broken by:

1. **Worse current standing** (or, in the offseason, worse finish in the most recent season)

2. **Larger remaining FAAB balance**
3. **Coin flip by the commissioner**

Using standings as the first tiebreaker rather than a rolling priority is deliberate: it gives struggling teams a small, consistent edge on the wire without creating a priority list that owners game by claiming and dropping.

7.4 In-Season Cutoffs

- **Waivers continue through the end of the championship week (Week 17).** Teams eliminated from contention retain full access to the wire.
- There is no roster freeze for non-playoff teams. Picking up a promising young player in Week 16 for next year is a legitimate dynasty move and this league encourages it.
- However: acquiring players in order to **help or harm another team's playoff run** is a violation. See Governance §9.3.

7.5 Offseason Free Agency

The wire stays live all offseason on the same daily FAAB schedule, using the **prior year's** remaining budgets until the rookie draft resets them.

This means an owner who spends to zero in November has no way to claim a free agent in March. That is intentional — budget management in a dynasty league should account for the whole calendar, not just the fantasy season.

Rookies who go undrafted in the rookie draft enter the free agent pool when the draft concludes and are claimed through normal waivers.

08 — Trades

Trading is the best part of a dynasty league. The rules here are deliberately permissive: the default answer to "can I trade this?" is yes.

8.1 What Can Be Traded

- Players on the active roster, taxi squad, or IR
- Rookie draft picks, within the pick-trading window

8.2 What Cannot Be Traded

- **Future considerations**, "I'll get you back next year," handshake side deals, or anything not fully executable on the platform at the moment the trade is accepted. If it can't be entered into Sleeper, it isn't a trade.
- **Real money**, in any direction, for any reason.
- **FAAB dollars.** See §8.4.
- **Loans of any kind**, including FAAB lent against a future budget.
- **Anything belonging to a third team.** You can only trade what you currently own.
- **Anything at all, until the startup draft is over.** Trading is closed until the final pick of the inaugural draft is made — no players, no draft slots, no picks within the startup, no FAAB. The startup draft order is set by the commissioner and is not for sale. See Startup Draft §5.4.

Every trade must be executed through Sleeper. An agreement reached in a group chat is not binding until it is accepted in the app.

8.3 Trading Draft Picks

Window: the current league year plus the next two. As of any moment, you may trade picks in up to three rookie drafts.

> Example: after the 2027 rookie draft concludes, teams may trade 2028, 2029, and 2030 picks. The 2030 picks become tradeable the moment the 2027 draft ends.

Three years is the standard. It is long enough for a real rebuild to be financed and short enough that a departing owner cannot mortgage a decade and vanish.

Dues requirement. *An owner who has not paid the current year's dues may not trade a future draft pick in either direction.* No exceptions. This is the mechanism that keeps future picks worth something.

Traded picks are tracked by the commissioner and reflected in Sleeper's draft pick ledger. If the platform and the commissioner's records disagree, the accepted trade in Sleeper's transaction log governs.

8.4 FAAB Is Not Tradeable

FAAB dollars may not be traded, sold, gifted, or included in a trade in any form. Your $100 is yours alone, for the whole league year.

FAAB trading is common in redraft leagues and it works badly in dynasty. A rebuilding team has no use for waiver money and every incentive to convert it into future picks, which quietly turns the budget into a second currency that contenders can buy — and the teams doing the selling are the same teams already under suspicion of tanking. Keeping FAAB non-transferable means every team's waiver budget reflects that team's own decisions, and a $47 winning bid means the same thing no matter who made it.

8.5 Trade Deadline

Trading closes at kickoff of the first game of Week 12 and reopens **immediately after the championship game concludes**.

Week 12 is the standard deadline and it lands in the right place: teams know by then whether they are contending, and the three remaining regular-season weeks are played out with the rosters everyone finished the deadline holding. Nobody sells a starter to a rival in Week 14 and reshapes a playoff race they are no longer in.

Offseason trading is unrestricted from the end of the championship game through Week 12 of the following season, subject to the dues rule in §8.3.

Startup year: trading opens for the first time when the final pick of the startup draft is made, and runs until the Week 12 deadline.

8.6 Collusion

Trades process automatically. There is no league vote and no veto by owners.

This is deliberate. Veto votes in fantasy leagues are almost always used by owners who dislike a trade's *value*, not its *integrity*, and a league where a good rebuild trade can be voted down is a league where nobody rebuilds.

The commissioner may reverse a trade only for collusion, defined as:

- A transfer of value intended to benefit one team at the expense of the league, without genuine competitive consideration
- A trade made to circumvent roster, FAAB, or dues rules
- A trade involving any consideration outside the league (money, favors, side deals)
- A trade by an owner who has announced or intends to abandon their team

Not collusion: a trade you think is bad. A lopsided-looking trade between a contender and a rebuilder. An owner overpaying for a player they love. A trade that helps your rival. Dynasty valuations differ enormously and that is the game.

Process. Any owner may raise a collusion concern to the commissioner within 48 hours of a trade processing. The commissioner investigates, hears from both parties, and rules. If the commissioner is a party to the trade, the co-commissioner rules. A reversal requires the commissioner to state the specific factual basis in the league chat.

Penalties for confirmed collusion, at the commissioner's discretion, escalating: trade reversal → forfeiture of the next rookie first-round pick → removal from the league by a 9-of-12 vote, with dues forfeited.

8.7 Trades and Vacant Teams

A team whose owner has been removed or has abandoned it is **frozen**: no trades in or out until a new owner is installed. Any trade accepted by an owner who is subsequently removed for abandonment within the following 14 days is subject to commissioner review.

A new owner inherits the roster and all pick obligations exactly as they are. Trades made by the previous owner are not undone.

8.8 The Annual Trade Requirement

Every owner must complete at least one trade each season to be eligible for a payout.

A team that finishes in the money without having made a trade that year does not collect. This is an engagement rule, not a competitive one — a dynasty league dies when half the owners stop transacting, and the season-long silence usually starts with one or two teams that set a lineup and never speak.

What counts. One completed trade with another team in this league, processed on Sleeper, involving at least one player or draft pick. Waiver claims, free agent adds, and taxi or IR moves are not trades. One trade is enough — there is no credit for more and no penalty for none beyond the payout forfeiture.

The window. From the opening of the league year on **February 1** through the Week 12 trade deadline. A trade made after your own season has ended but before the deadline still counts. Year one is the exception: the window opens when the startup draft ends, because trading is closed until then.

December and January trades do not count. Trading reopens the moment the championship ends (§8.5), but the league year does not turn over until February 1. A trade made in that gap counts toward neither season — not the one just finished, whose payouts are already settled, and not the one to come. If you want the requirement satisfied, trade on or after February 1. This is a real window of a few weeks, so it is worth knowing about rather than discovering in December.

Sham trades do not count. Swapping a 2029 fourth for a 2029 fourth to tick the box is not a trade, and neither is any exchange arranged for the sole purpose of satisfying this section. The commissioner may rule a trade non-qualifying for this purpose without reversing it — the trade stands, it just does not buy eligibility. A trade later reversed for collusion under §8.6 never counted in the first place.

Forfeited shares pass down. If an ineligible team finishes in a payout position, that share goes to the next eligible team in the same category: champion to runner-up, runner-up to third place, most regular-season points to the next-highest eligible scorer. Money never leaves the pool and never returns to the commissioner.

Warning. The commissioner posts a list of teams that have not yet traded in the league chat after Week 8 and again in the week before the deadline. Nobody should lose a payout to a rule they forgot, but the reminder is a courtesy — the requirement stands whether or not it is posted.

09 — Governance & Conduct

A redraft league that goes badly is over in four months. A dynasty league that goes badly poisons a decade. This section exists because the rules that keep a dynasty league alive are not the rules about football.

9.1 Amendments

When. Rule change proposals may be submitted between **February 1 and March 1** each year — after the season ends, before dues are due and before the rookie draft. There is no other amendment window.

No mid-season rule changes. None, for any reason, including obviously good ideas. The only exception is correcting a platform setting that does not match this document, which the commissioner does immediately and announces.

Process.

1. Any owner submits a written proposal to the league chat before March 1.
2. Discussion period of at least 1 day.
3. The commissioner calls a vote with a stated deadline of at least 24 hours.
4. Passed amendments take effect for the coming season and are written into this rulebook, with the change noted in the change log.

A non-vote counts as a vote against. An owner who does not respond before the stated deadline is recorded as opposed. This applies to **every league vote** — amendments, expulsions, commissioner removal, and approving a new owner alike. Silence defeats proposals, so an owner who wants the league to be able to change anything has to actually vote. See §9.2.

9.2 Voting

Every league vote requires 9 of 12 owners in favor, with one exception. A scoring tweak, a roster change, expelling an owner, and removing the commissioner all clear the same bar. Approving a new owner for a vacant team does not.

Decision	Threshold
Any rule amendment	**9 of 12**
Scoring change	**9 of 12**
Roster size, starting lineup, or Superflex status	**9 of 12**
League size change	**9 of 12**
Rookie draft order method	**9 of 12**
Expelling an owner	**9 of 12**
Removing the commissioner	**9 of 12**
Approving a new owner for a vacant team	**Simple majority** of the remaining active owners — 6 of 11 with one team vacant (§9.5)

Why orphan approval is the exception. Every other vote on this list changes the rules, and stability is worth more than speed. Filling a vacant team is the opposite: it is time-sensitive, the alternative to approving a candidate is an unmanaged roster sitting in the league, and a 9-of-12 bar would let three quiet owners leave a team empty through the offseason. A simple majority is enough to reject someone the league genuinely does not want.

The bar is set high deliberately. In a dynasty league the rules *are* asset values — a change to the passing touchdown value or the starting lineup reprices every roster in the league and rewards whoever saw it coming. Requiring near-consensus means an owner can trade for a 2029 pick without worrying that seven people will quietly change what that pick is worth.

The cost is real and worth naming: a genuinely broken rule can survive because four owners could not be bothered to vote. Two mitigations follow from that.

A non-vote counts as a vote against. This is stated in §9.1 and applies to every vote in the table above, including the simple-majority one. It matters much more under a 9-of-12 threshold than it would under a majority — silence defeats proposals. Owners who want the league to be able to fix itself have to actually show up.

The commissioner votes as an owner and has no tiebreaking or veto power on amendments.

9.3 Tanking and Lineup Integrity

Every owner must field a complete, legal, healthy starting lineup every week of the season, including weeks in which they are eliminated, on a bye in the toilet bowl, or playing a meaningless game.

Specifically prohibited:

- Leaving a starting slot empty
- Starting a player on a bye week, or listed **Out** or on **IR**, when a healthy alternative is on your roster
- Dropping productive players to weaken your own team
- Acquiring or starting players for the purpose of helping or harming another team's playoff position
- Refusing to engage in trades or waivers for the purpose of finishing lower
- Treating a **placement game** as meaningless. The 5th and 3rd place games decide picks 1.07–1.10 (Schedule §4.2); a team eliminated from the championship is still playing for something every remaining week.

Not prohibited: trading veterans for picks, starting young players over established ones to evaluate them, or building for next year. **Rebuilding is legitimate and expected. Sabotage is not.** The distinction is whether you are trying to *win the games you are playing* with the roster you have chosen to assemble.

Enforcement.

Offense	Consequence
First illegal or incomplete lineup	Written warning in the league chat
Second	Forfeiture of the team's highest remaining rookie pick after round 1
Third	Forfeiture of the team's next first-round rookie pick
Pattern of deliberate tanking	Expulsion vote (9 of 12), dues forfeited

The commissioner enforces §9.3 on their own initiative, not only on complaint.

9.4 Inactivity

An owner is **inactive** if any of the following occur:

- Two consecutive weeks with an incomplete starting lineup
- Seven days without responding to a direct message from the commissioner during the season, or fourteen days during the offseason
- Failing to respond to a leaguewide vote or a scheduling poll twice in the same league year

Process. Warning in the league chat and by direct message → seven days to respond → if unresolved, the commissioner declares the team **vacant** and the roster is frozen (§8.7).

Unpaid dues run on their own clock, not this one. An owner who misses the March 1 dues deadline gets one written warning and **seven days from March 1** — March 8, not a second grace period stacked on top of the first. If the dues are not paid by then the team is vacant. See Structure §1.4.

An owner who knows they will be unavailable (travel, illness, life) should tell the commissioner in advance and name a temporary lineup-setter. Announced absences are not inactivity.

Trading is participation. Separately from this section, every owner must complete at least one trade per season to be eligible for a payout — see Trades §8.8. Going a season without a single trade is not by itself inactivity, but it is usually the first visible sign of it.

9.5 Vacant Teams (Orphans)

Vacant teams are the leading cause of death for dynasty leagues. This league treats filling them as the commissioner's highest-priority duty.

Filling a vacancy, in order of preference:

1. **The departing owner finds their own replacement.** Owners leaving voluntarily are expected to do this, and to give the commissioner at least 30 days' notice. This is by far the best outcome.
2. **A friend of an existing owner**, nominated in the league chat. Every owner should be asked before the search goes any wider — a candidate somebody already knows is worth more than a stranger with a better résumé.
3. **A public search**, run by the commissioner. Post the opening where dynasty players actually look, screen candidates yourself, and share the roster and this constitution with anyone who asks. Do not hand a team to the first person who replies.

If a vacancy cannot be filled by the start of the rookie draft, the commissioner runs the team under **interim management** below until it can be. A well-managed empty seat is survivable for a season; a bad owner is not.

Terms for an incoming owner.

- The new owner takes the roster and all draft-pick obligations **exactly as they are**. No roster reset, no restocking, no compensatory picks by default. This is the standard, and it is what keeps existing owners' assets honest — a rebuilt orphan devalues every pick anyone traded for.

- The new owner pays the full annual dues for the current year. If the departing owner already paid, the incoming owner reimburses them.
- New owners must be approved by a **simple majority of the remaining active owners** — 6 of 11 while one team is vacant. This is the one league vote that does not require 9 of 12; see §9.2. A non-vote counts against, so owners should answer the approval poll promptly.

Distressed teams. If a vacant team is genuinely uncompetitive — a bottom-two roster with few future picks — it may be unfillable on standard terms. In that case the commissioner may declare the team distressed and award the incoming owner **one additional second-round rookie pick** in the next rookie draft, inserted at the end of round 2 rather than taken from another team.

This is applied only by commissioner declaration, must be announced **before the team is advertised**, and is used sparingly. A compensatory pick costs the league no cash and does not touch anyone's existing assets; the trade-off is that it lengthens round 2 and can feel unfair to the team that finished just above the orphan in the standings. If the commissioner is declaring teams distressed more than about once every few years, the problem is league health, not orphan terms.

Interim management. While a team is vacant, the commissioner sets its lineup each week using Sleeper's optimal-lineup projection. The team makes no trades and no waiver claims.

9.6 Conduct

- Do not ghost. If you want out, say so and help find a replacement. Leaving well costs you nothing and leaving badly is remembered for years.
- Answer trade offers, even to decline. A one-word "no thanks" within a day or two is the entire social contract of a dynasty league.
- Disputes go to the commissioner privately first, not to the league chat.

Repeated conduct violations are grounds for an expulsion vote (9 of 12). An expelled owner forfeits their dues and their team is handled as a vacancy.

9.7 Change Log

Date	Change	Vote
09/04/2026	Constitution adopted	Unanimous

10 — League Calendar

The dynasty year does not stop. This is the annual cycle.

The Year at a Glance

When	What
Immediately after the championship game	Trading reopens. Rookie draft order is set and posted in the league group text.
February 1	New league year opens. Amendment proposals open. Dues invoiced.
March 1	**Dues deadline** ($25 in year one, +$10 each year). Amendment proposals close.
Early–mid March	NFL free agency. The busiest trading window of the year.
Mid-March	Amendment votes concluded; rulebook updated.
Late April	NFL Draft.
Within 3 days of the NFL Draft	Commissioner posts the rookie draft date poll.
Within 4 weeks of the NFL Draft	**Rookie draft.** Live, 4 rounds, linear, 90-second clock, ~1 hour. Date set annually by availability.
Conclusion of rookie draft	FAAB budgets reset to $100 for all teams.
Late August	Final roster compliance check.
NFL Week 1 kickoff	**Taxi squad deadline** (year one: Week 2). Rosters must be legal. Season begins.
Weeks 1–14	Regular season. Daily waivers at 3:00 AM ET.
After Week 8	Commissioner posts which teams have not yet made their required annual trade (§8.8).
Week 11	Second and final reminder on the annual trade requirement.
Week 12, first kickoff	**Trade deadline.** Last chance to satisfy the annual trade requirement.
Weeks 15–17	Playoffs (6 teams, with 5th- and 3rd-place games for draft slots) and the **toilet bowl** (6 teams, losers advance).
Week 17	Championship.
Within 14 days of championship	Payouts distributed, to eligible teams only.

Deadlines That Actually Matter

These four are the ones that cause problems when missed:

1. **March 1 — dues.** Miss it and you cannot trade future picks, and after seven days your team is declared vacant. This is the deadline the whole dynasty economy rests on.

2. **Rookie draft night.** It is live and about an hour, and the date moves every year — vote in the poll and put it in your calendar the day it is announced. If you cannot make it, queue your players; autopick does not care that you were busy.
3. **Week 1 kickoff — taxi deadline.** After this moment no player can be moved *onto* taxi for the rest of the season. If you meant to stash a rookie, do it in August. **The inaugural season is the one exception** — year one's taxi deadline is Week 2 kickoff, because the startup draft leaves no offseason to sort a roster out. Rosters must still be legal at Week 1 either way.
4. **Week 12 first kickoff — trade deadline.** Sleeper enforces this automatically and the commissioner will not reopen it.

Offseason Rhythm

Dynasty leagues die in June and July. Some things that keep them alive, none of which are rules:

- Post the rookie draft order the week it is set, with commentary.
- Do a group rookie-class watch or a mock draft in April.
- Publish a leaguewide power ranking after NFL free agency.
- Keep the league chat alive during the NFL Draft itself — it is the second-best night of the fantasy year.

Commissioner's Annual Checklist

☐ Announce the rookie draft order in the group text as soon as the championship ends

☐ Post the rookie draft date poll within 3 days of the NFL Draft; announce the date with 10+ days' notice

☐ Collect dues by March 1; confirm every team in the league chat

☐ Run the amendment window; update the rulebook and the change log

☐ Reset all 12 FAAB budgets manually after the rookie draft — *Sleeper does not do this for you*

☐ Verify Sleeper settings against the appendix before Week 1

☐ Confirm all rosters legal at Week 1 kickoff

☐ Post the annual-trade-requirement status after Week 8 and again in Week 11

☐ Post the toilet bowl bracket in the group text before Week 15 and track it weekly

☐ Confirm eliminated playoff teams have Week 16 / Week 17 placement matchups; pair them by hand if Sleeper does not

☐ Confirm payout eligibility (§8.8) before distributing

☐ Distribute payouts within 14 days of the championship

Appendix A — Sleeper Settings

Every rule in this constitution mapped to the actual Sleeper toggle that implements it. Use this to configure the league, and re-verify it every August.

League Settings

Sleeper setting	Value
Total teams	12
League type	**Dynasty** (Keeper: all)
Divisions	0
Scoring	Custom (see below)
Trade deadline	Week 12
Trade review	**None / automatic**
Waiver type	**FAAB**
Waiver budget	100
Waiver clear days	2
Waiver process time	3:00 AM ET, daily
Playoff teams	6
Playoff start week	15
Playoff round type	1 week per round
Playoff seed type	Re-seed
Championship week	17
Consolation bracket	**On** — but see the toilet bowl note below

Roster Settings

Slot	Count
QB	1
RB	2
WR	3
TE	1
FLEX (RB/WR/TE)	2
SUPER_FLEX (QB/RB/WR/TE)	1
BN (bench)	13
IR	3
Taxi	3
Active roster size	**23**

No K and no D/ST slots. Set both to 0.

Taxi Squad Settings

Setting	Value
Taxi slots	3
Allow non-rookies for taxi	**Off**
Max years experience	1
Taxi deadline	**Week 2 for the inaugural season, Week 1 every year after**

> **Sleeper quirk:** players cannot be added directly to a taxi slot. They must be claimed to the active roster first, then moved. Tell your league this before the rookie draft — it catches new dynasty owners every year.

> **Sleeper quirk:** Sleeper has no taxi-raiding feature and this league does not want one. Nothing to configure.

> **Change this after year one.** Sleeper's taxi deadline is a week number. Set it to **2** for the inaugural season and to **1** every season after (Rosters §2.3). It is on the annual reset checklist below because it is the single easiest setting to leave stale.

Startup Draft Settings

Setting	Value
Draft type	Snake
Rounds	20
Pick timer	**90 seconds at start** — stepped to 35s before R4, 15s before R11
Draft order	Manual, set by the commissioner
Trades during draft	**Disabled**

Stepping the clock. Sleeper has one pick-timer value, but the commissioner can change it while the draft is live. Two changes only: before **round 4** drop to 35s, before **round 11** drop to 15s. See Startup Draft §5.3.

> **Do a dry run.** Open a throwaway mock draft and practice changing the timer mid-draft *before* draft night. Finding the setting for the first time with 12 people watching and a 90-second clock running is not the moment to learn the UI.

Scoring Settings

Set scoring to **Custom** and enter these exactly:

Stat	Sleeper key	Value
Passing yards	`pass_yd`	0.04
Passing TD	`pass_td`	4
Interception	`pass_int`	−2
2pt pass	`pass_2pt`	2
Rushing yards	`rush_yd`	0.1
Rushing TD	`rush_td`	6
2pt rush	`rush_2pt`	2
Reception	`rec`	1.0
Reception (TE)	`bonus_rec_te`	0
Receiving yards	`rec_yd`	0.1
Receiving TD	`rec_td`	6
2pt reception	`rec_2pt`	2
Fumble lost	`fum_lost`	−2
Fumble recovery TD	`fum_rec_td`	6
Kick return TD	`kr_td`	6
Punt return TD	`pr_td`	6

Set every bonus category (`bonus_rush_yd_100` , `bonus_pass_yd_300` , etc.) to **0**.

> Return touchdowns sit under special teams in Sleeper's custom scoring rather than with the offensive categories. Confirm the two return keys are set — they are the easiest rows on this table to scroll past, and they implement §3.4.

Annual Reset Checklist

Sleeper does **not** do these automatically. The commissioner must do them by hand each year:

1. **Reset FAAB budgets to $100** for all 12 teams, after the rookie draft.
2. **Set the rookie draft order** — Sleeper does not know this league's ordering rules (§6.2): non-playoff teams in reverse standings, then playoff teams worst finish to champion.
3. **Create the rookie draft** with the correct type (linear), rounds (4), and a flat 90-second clock — and set the date agreed in the annual availability poll.
4. **Re-verify taxi eligibility settings** — experience thresholds roll over at season end and are easy to leave stale. **Before season two, change the taxi deadline from Week 2 to Week 1** and leave it there permanently.
5. **Confirm the trade deadline week** after Sleeper's season rollover.

Known Divergences

Sleeper cannot enforce these rules. They are enforced by the commissioner:

- The **dues-paid requirement for trading future picks** (§8.3) — Sleeper has no concept of dues.
- The **lineup integrity / anti-tanking rules** (§9.3) — Sleeper will happily let a team start six players on bye.
- The **48-hour window to move a cleared IR player** — Sleeper flags the illegal roster but does not act on it.
- **Playoff stat corrections** (§3.6) — the commissioner must check manually before payouts.
- The **annual trade requirement for payout eligibility** (§8.8) — Sleeper logs every trade but has no notion of a per-season minimum. Read the transaction log before paying anyone.
- The **taxi promotion deadline being one-way** — Sleeper enforces the direction correctly, but nothing stops an owner from promoting a taxi player they meant to keep stashed. That is on the owner.
- The **placement games** (§4.2) — the 5th place game in Week 16 and the 3rd place game in Week 17 decide picks 1.07–1.10. Confirm before Week 15 that eliminated playoff teams actually have Week 16 and Week 17 matchups; if Sleeper does not schedule them, pair the teams by hand and announce it in the group text.
- The **toilet bowl** (§4.5) — Sleeper's consolation bracket advances winners; the toilet bowl advances losers. Leave the consolation bracket on so the six non-playoff teams still get scheduled matchups, then post and track the real bracket in the group text. The trophy goes to the team that loses the Week 17 final, regardless of what Sleeper's bracket displays.